VON ZAROVICH ESTATE / STATION 2

The Alchemist’s Laboratory

Something sweet. Something sulfurous.

Warm air rolls out of the laboratory, carrying the smell of burnt sugar, old candle wax, and something that probably should not be bubbling. Glass tubes twist through the shadows like transparent roots. Somewhere behind a cupboard, a tiny drip keeps time.

Ten amber bottles stand in a brass rack, numbered one through ten. Each has the same dark contents and a black wax seal. In the wavering lamplight, they look exactly alike. No helpful label says what is inside.

A two-pan brass balance occupies the workbench. Its beam hangs beneath the spread wings of a grinning metal bat. Both pans are empty. Nearby, a writing desk disappears beneath papers and ink stains, while dusty ingredient jars crowd a crooked shelf.

In front of the sealed iron exit, a stone jester holds out a shallow brass bowl. Its cap curls into horns; its carved grin is much too wide. The bowl is empty. The jester looks delighted about that.

A green bubble rises in a distant flask and bursts with a rude little pop. The silence afterward feels expectant.

What do you do? Talk with your partner. Tell the DM what you want to examine or try. Your character sheet may give you ideas.